

Cleveland Fintech

Threat Intelligence Investigation Report

Topic: Malware Analysis

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Date of Investigation: 21 June 2026

Target Organization: Cleveland Fintech

Section 1: Surface Identification

S/N	Attribute	Captured Investigation Data		
		File Name	File Type	Digital Fingerprint (Hash)
1	DarkGate	setup.exe	EXE (Win32 Executable / peexe)	SHA256: dab701feecc382b037b61b4268f1f796c28f3c30d77e18506cb1646bf9cb0 SHA1: f3a403871eee2abf3d4150c3b0dbd878c8c80c31 MD5: 358e54bf814e5c420568c0af8cd13df9

Attribute	Additional File Metadata
Functions	Remote Access Trojan (RAT); Backdoor; Information stealer
File Size	1.59 MB (1,666,928 bytes)
Date of Creation	2025-10-21 14:56:49 UTC

Section 2: Infrastructure & Network Relations

Attribute	Captured Investigation Data
Antivirus Detection Score	52 / 71 security vendors
Vendors Flagging File as Malicious	13
Related Malicious Artifacts	.rsrc/1033/RCDATA/CABINET; Autolt3.exe; Palestine_xlm
Command & Control (C2) Connections	C2 framework is designed to blend into normal web traffic while maintaining persistent access to compromised systems.
Malicious IP Addresses	176.126.86.247; 192.121.108.99
Contacted Domains / Websites	http://70.36.99.253:15888/gateway/l29mnvj4.0qno9

Section 3: Attacker Playbook Mapping (MITRE ATT&CK)

Attribute	Behavior Profile 1	Behavior Profile 2
Technique ID & Name	T1027 – Obfuscated Files or Information	T1059 – Command and Scripting Interpreter
Attacker's Goal (Tactic)	Stealth	Execution
Detection Strategy	Abnormal command-line syntax or PowerShell obfuscation.	Behavioral detection of scripting/command interpreter abuse (e.g. powershell.exe, cmd.exe, wscript.exe).
Mitigations	Behavior prevention on endpoint. On Windows 10+, enable Attack Surface Reduction (ASR) rules to block execution of potentially obfuscated payloads.	Antivirus/Antimalware to automatically quarantine suspicious files. Code signing where possible, to permit execution of signed scripts only.
What the Malware Is Doing	Encrypt, encode, or otherwise obfuscate executables or file contents on the system or in transit — common behavior used to evade defenses.	Abuses command and scripting interpreters to execute commands, scripts, or binaries.

Section 4: Executive Summary for Cleveland Fintech

Attribute	Details
Prepared For	Cleveland Fintech Security Operations Center (SOC)
Threat Classification	Critical — Remote Access Trojan (RAT) & Loader
Summary of Findings	We have successfully profiled the malware sample targeting our network, identified by the permanent digital fingerprint SHA256: dab701feecc382b037b61b4268f1f796c28f3c30d77e18506cb1646bf9cb0b. Our lab analysis confirms this file belongs to the DarkGate threat group and establishes unauthorized communications with this website http://70.36.99.253:15888/gateway/l29mnvj4.0qno9 to bypass our outer perimeter.
Attacker Technique Observed	Once inside a system, the malware utilizes the MITRE ATT&CK technique Non-Standard Port to achieve Command and Control on our workstations. It routes outbound HTTP/HTTPS beacons through unmonitored channels to blend in with legitimate traffic and maintain a stealthy, persistent connection with the attacker's infrastructure.
Recommended Action	To proactively protect Cleveland Fintech's consumer databases, the SOC team must immediately block the logged IP addresses: 176.126.86.247; 192.121.108.99 at the firewall and update Intrusion Detection Systems to spot this specific playbook behavior.